

SIMS

School Information Management System

[Instruction & User Manual](#)

<https://sims-918c4.web.app>

Version 1.0 · July 2026

Multi-school platform for Zambian schools · CBC School-Based Assessment (SBA)

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1 • Introduction

SIMS is a web-based School Information Management System built for Zambian schools. It manages the full academic life of a school — student admission and records, teachers and teaching assignments, the CBC School-Based Assessment (SBA) workflow from marks entry through moderation, approval and ECZ export, report cards and transcripts, fee tracking, and student transfers between SIMS schools.

You use SIMS in a web browser — no installation is required. It works on computers, tablets and phones:

Web address: <https://sims-918c4.web.app>

Bookmark this address. Use a modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari).

1.1 Who uses SIMS — roles

Every user account has a role. Your role decides which menus you see and what you may do.

Role	What they do in SIMS
School Administrator	Sets up the school (profile, structure, subjects), registers teachers and staff, creates login accounts, admits students, manages fees, and has full access to all modules.
Head Teacher	Oversees the whole school: admits students, manages teachers and assignments, moderates and approves SBA results, initiates/decides transfers, views reports.
Deputy Head	Reviews and approves SBA submissions, monitors readiness, handles ECZ export, views reports.
Head of Department (HOD)	Builds SBA plans, enters marks where needed, moderates submitted class score sheets, monitors readiness and reports.
Teacher	Works from “My Classes”: enters SBA marks for their own classes and submits them for review. Can view student records.
System Administrator	Platform level only — registers new schools onto SIMS, provisions the first School Administrator account, and enables optional paid add-ons (e.g. SBA evidence attachments) on a school's request. School staff never need this role.

2 · Getting started — signing in

2.1 Your account

You do not register yourself. Accounts are created for you:

- The **School Administrator** account is created when the school is registered on SIMS.
- **Staff accounts** (Head Teacher, Deputy, HOD, additional administrators) are created by the School Administrator under [Staff Accounts](#).
- **Teacher logins** are created by the School Administrator from the teacher's profile page.

In each case you will be given your **email address** and a **temporary password**. The temporary password is shown to your administrator **only once**, at the moment the account is created — keep it safe until your first sign-in.

2.2 First sign-in

- 1 Open **<https://sims-918c4.web.app>** in your browser.
- 2 Enter your email address and the temporary password, then press **Sign in**.
- 3 SIMS will immediately ask you to **set a new password**. You cannot use the system until you do. Enter the temporary password once more, choose a new private password, and confirm.
- 4 The app reloads and you land on your dashboard.

Keep your password private. Marks, approvals and payments are recorded against *your* account. There is currently no self-service “forgot password” — if you are locked out, contact your School Administrator / system administrator.

2.3 Changing your password later

Click **Change password** in the header (top-right, near your name) at any time. You will be asked for your current password and a new one.

2.4 Signing out

Use the **Sign out** button in the header. Always sign out on shared computers.

3 · Finding your way around

3.1 The screen layout

- **Header (top)** — your school's name and logo, the **academic context bar**, your name, [Change password](#) and [Sign out](#).
- **Sidebar (left)** — the menu. It only shows the pages your role may use, grouped under *Academics* and *Administration*. Red number badges show items waiting for your action (e.g. sheets to review, transfer requests).
- **Main area** — the page you are working on.

3.2 The academic context bar — important

In the header you will find dropdowns for **Year**, **Term**, and where relevant **Form** and **Stream**. Many pages (Teaching, SBA Plans, SBA Marks, My Classes, Reports) show data *for the selected year and term*. If a page looks empty, first check that the correct year and term are selected. Your selection is remembered on that device.

3.3 Menu overview

Menu item	Purpose	Who sees it
Dashboard	Role-based cockpit: KPIs, pending actions, SBA pipeline	Everyone
My Tasks	One inbox of everything waiting on you, with links (Section 3.4)	All school staff
My Classes	A teacher's own classes and score sheets	Teacher, HOD, Head, Deputy
Students / Student Registry	Student dashboard, full searchable register	Admin, Head, Teacher
Academic Structure	Years, terms, forms (levels) and streams (classes)	Admin manages; staff view
Teachers	Teacher HR registry and profiles	Admin, Head
Transfers	Student transfers between SIMS schools	Admin, Head
Subjects	Subject catalogue (incl. SBA flag)	Admin manages; staff view
Teaching	Assign teachers to stream + subject per term	Admin, Head
SBA Plans / Marks / Review / Readiness / ECZ Export	The full SBA workflow (Section 7)	Per role — see Section 7
Reports	School-wide SBA compliance and completion	Admin, Head, Deputy, HOD
School Profile	School details, logo, grading scale	Admin
Staff Accounts	Create/deactivate staff logins	Admin
Payments	Fee register and clearance (non-government schools)	Admin, Head

3.4 My Tasks — start your day here

My Tasks is one inbox that answers "*what needs my attention today?*" for your role, so you don't have to check each module:

- **Teachers** — score sheets returned for correction (one row per class, linked straight to the sheet) and sheets still in draft.
- **HODs, Deputies, Head Teachers** — sheets awaiting moderation or final approval, incoming transfer requests to decide, and transfers where the other school asked for information.
- **Administrators & Head Teachers** — students with no class assigned, SBA students missing an examination number, staff accounts still on temporary passwords, and the ECZ submission deadline once it is near.

Every row links directly to the page where the work happens. The red badge on the **My Tasks** menu item shows your count at a glance, and both dashboards link here via **All tasks** →. When the list is empty, you're up to date.

4 · Setting up your school (School Administrator)

Do these once, in this order, before admitting students:

Setup checklist: ① School Profile → ② Academic Structure (year, terms, forms, streams) → ③ Subjects → ④ Register teachers → ⑤ Teaching assignments → ⑥ Staff accounts → ⑦ Admit students → ⑧ SBA plans.

4.1 School profile, logo and grading scale

Open [School Profile](#). Each section has its own **Edit** button:

- **General** — school name, type, ownership, principal, motto.
- **Contact** — phone, email, website.
- **Location** — province, district, physical and postal address.
- **Branding** — upload your school logo (image up to 2 MB). The logo appears in the header and on printed report cards, transcripts and certificates.
- **Grading scale** — the mark bands (e.g. 0–49 Fail ... 80–100 Excellent) used for the *Grade* column on report cards. Edit the band boundaries and labels to match your school's policy.
- **ECZ examinations** — the school's **examination centre number** (printed on the ECZ SBA export) and the **SBA submission deadline**. The deadline defaults to the ECZ norm of 31 January of the following year, but stays editable in case ECZ changes or extends it.
- **Registration & subscription** — read-only; school code, EMIS number and subscription are managed at platform level.

4.2 Academic structure

Open [Academic Structure](#). Work through the tabs:

- 1 **Years** — confirm the current academic year.
- 2 **Terms** — confirm the terms of the year.
- 3 **Levels** — the forms offered (F1–F4).
- 4 **Streams** — create a stream (class) for each form, e.g. F1 A, F1 B: choose the form, give a short **code** (A, B, GREEN...), a display name and a **capacity** (number of seats). The occupied count updates automatically as students are enrolled.
- 5 **Departments** — the school starts with a default set (Languages, Mathematics, Sciences, Commercial, Practical, Arts) which you can freely **add to, rename or deactivate** to match your school. Renaming updates every subject and teacher in that department; deactivating hides it from pickers without affecting existing assignments.

Renaming a stream code: editing a stream's code moves all its enrolments to the new code automatically. If the stream already has teaching assignments or SBA score sheets, the rename is refused — deactivate the old stream and create a new one instead.

4.3 Subjects

Open **Subjects** and add each subject taught. The quickest way is the "**Start from the ECZ subject list**" dropdown: it carries the official subject catalogue from the ECZ CBA blueprint (Mathematics, English Language, Biology, Chemistry, Physics, Civic Education, History, Geography, Religious Education, Zambian Languages, Literature in English, Computer Studies/ICT, Physical Education and Sport, Art and Design, Music Arts, Food and Nutrition, Travel and Tourism, Agricultural Science) and prefills the name, a suggested code and the usual department — keeping subject names consistent across SIMS schools. You can **change the code** to your school's own before saving, adjust the department, or pick **Custom subject** to add anything not on the list. Set the **forms where it is offered** and whether it is **SBA-enabled** (counts for CBC School-Based Assessment) — only SBA-enabled subjects appear in SBA planning.

4.4 Staff accounts

Open **Staff Accounts** to create logins for the Head Teacher, Deputy Head, HODs, or additional administrators:

- 1 Click **Create account**, enter name, email and role.
- 2 The temporary password is displayed **once** — copy it and hand it to the staff member securely.
- 3 On first sign-in they will be forced to set their own password (Section 2.2).

The same page lists all school accounts and lets you **Deactivate** / **Reactivate** them (you cannot deactivate yourself). Deactivated users can no longer sign in.

Note: Teacher logins are *not* created here — they are created from the teacher's profile page so the login is linked to the HR record (Section 5.2).

5 · Teachers & teaching assignments

5.1 Registering a teacher

Open [Teachers](#) → **Register teacher**. Fill in the personal and professional details (name, gender, contact, department, employment type, qualification, TSC number). On save the teacher receives a permanent employee number (e.g. **EMP-000001**). This creates the *HR record* only — it is not yet a login.

The **Teacher Registry** lists all teachers; click one to open their profile, where an administrator can **Edit** details.

5.2 Giving a teacher a login account

- 1 Open the teacher's profile (the teacher must have an **email address** on record and be active).
- 2 In the **Login account** section click **Create login account**.
- 3 The email + temporary password are shown **once** — copy and deliver them securely.
- 4 The teacher signs in, sets a new password, and from then on sees [My Classes](#) and [SBA Marks](#) for their own classes.

5.3 Teaching assignments (who teaches what)

Open [Teaching](#). Check the year and term in the header context bar, then assign: **teacher + subject + stream + periods per week**. One teacher holds each (stream, subject) slot per term; assigning over an occupied slot warns you first. The **Teaching Load** view shows each teacher's periods, subjects, streams and workload percentage, so you can balance loads.

Why this matters for SBA: the teaching assignment is what links a teacher to a class score sheet — a teacher can only enter marks for classes assigned to them.

6 · Student management

6.1 Admitting a student

Open [Students](#) → **Admit student** (administrators and head teachers). The wizard has five steps:

- 1 **Personal** — names, gender, date of birth. The admission number is generated automatically; the EMIS number is inherited from the school.
- 2 **Guardian** — parent/guardian details and contacts.
- 3 **Placement** — choose the form and a **stream** from the list (remaining seats are shown; full streams are disabled).
- 4 **Medical** — any medical notes.
- 5 **Review** — check everything and press **Admit**.

On success SIMS shows the generated numbers: student number (**STU-000123**), admission number (**ADM-2026-000045**) and guardian number (**GRD-000067**). Each student is also minted a permanent **SIMS Learner ID (SL-2026-...)** that follows them for life, even across school transfers.

Connectivity: admission needs an internet connection — it reserves official numbers, which cannot be done offline.

6.2 Student registry

Student Registry is the full register: search by name or number, filter by form, stream, status, gender or admission year, and **Export CSV** for use in Excel. Click any row to open the student's profile.

6.3 The student profile

Tabs on the profile page:

- **Profile** — personal details, student ID, status.
- **Enrollment** — enrolment history (form, stream, year).
- **Guardians** — linked guardians; click through to a guardian's profile and their other children.
- **Documents** — upload birth certificates, results slips etc. (PDF or images up to 10 MB), download or delete (delete is admin-only).
- **SBA** — the student's SBA results per form year, plus the combined Forms 2+3 score (Section 7).
- **Timeline / Audit** — history of what happened to the record (audit is admin-only).

The header of the profile links to the printable **Report card**, **Transcript** and, for administrators, **Transfer out** (Section 9).

6.4 Class placement banner

If a student has no class assigned (for example, after arriving by transfer), an amber **“No class assigned”** banner appears at the top of their profile. Administrators and head teachers choose a stream there (capacity-aware) to place the student.

7 · School-Based Assessment (SBA)

7.1 The rules SIMS enforces

- SBA applies to **Forms 2 and 3**, in **SBA-enabled subjects**.
- Each subject follows an **assessment plan**: a list of tasks, each with its own maximum marks.
- Teachers record **raw scores per task**. SIMS computes the total out of 100: $(\text{sum obtained} \div \text{sum maximum}) \times 100$, rounded.
- **Schools never apply the ECZ 30%/40% weighting** — ECZ weights centrally. SIMS exports raw marks only. (This is the most common ECZ submission error; SIMS makes it impossible.)
- Once a class sheet is **approved** by school leadership, its marks are **frozen permanently** — nobody can alter them, which is what makes the results credible for export.

7.2 The workflow at a glance



A reviewer can also **Return** a sheet for correction (it reopens for the teacher, who fixes and resubmits), and administrators can withdraw a submitted sheet back to draft. Every action is recorded in the sheet's **history** with who, when and any comment.

7.3 SBA Plans (HOD / Head / Admin)

- 1 Open **SBA Plans**; check the year in the context bar.
- 2 Click **New plan**: pick the form (F2/F3) and an SBA-enabled subject offered at that form.
- 3 Add the tasks (name, type, maximum marks, optionally the term each task belongs to). The running total is shown.
- 4 Save as **draft**; when the plan is final, **Publish** it. Only published plans can be scored against, and a published plan's tasks are locked.

7.4 Entering marks (Teacher)

- 1 Open **My Classes** — each card is one of your classes with its SBA progress. Click a class (or open **SBA Marks** and pick form, stream and subject).
- 2 The score sheet lists your class roster with a column per task. Enter whole-number scores up to each task's maximum.
- 3 Mark any student who does not take the subject as **Not taking**.
- 4 **Save** as you go — you can return any time while the sheet is in draft. The running total and percentage update live.
- 5 When every student is complete, press **Submit for review**. The sheet locks for you and moves to the HOD.

Returned sheet? If a reviewer returns your sheet, it appears on your dashboard and My Classes with a **Returned** badge and the reviewer's comment. Correct the marks and submit again.

7.5 Moderation and approval (HOD / Deputy / Head)

Open **SBA Review**. Filter the class sheets by status. For each sheet you can **View** the marks, then:

- **Moderate** (HOD) — confirms departmental review of a submitted sheet.
- **Approve** (Head / Deputy) — final sign-off. The marks are recomputed server-side, **frozen**, and become read-only for everyone.
- **Return** — send back to the teacher with a comment explaining what to fix.

Each action can carry a comment; the per-sheet **History** shows the full trail, and a resubmitted sheet shows its version number (v2, v3...).

7.6 Readiness — is the school on track?

SBA Readiness shows one progress bar per form + subject, rolled up across its streams, from *Planning* through *Approved*. Use it to see at a glance which subjects are behind. Each class chip links to its printable class register.

7.7 Examination numbers and ECZ export

- 1 Open **SBA Marks** group → **Exam numbers** page (`/assessments/exam-numbers`): pick the form and stream, type each student's ECZ examination number, and save (admin / head teacher).
- 2 Open **ECZ Export**: choose the form and subject. SIMS shows validation tiles — **Ready, Missing exam number, Not yet approved**.
- 3 Only students whose marks are **approved (frozen)** and who have an exam number are exported. Fix the listed exceptions first.
- 4 Click **Export for ECZ** for the official CSV — it carries the ECZ header block (subject, form, school, examination centre number, year) followed by examination number, student and raw mark — or **School copy (per-task)** for an internal file with every task column. You can also print the list.

Deadline reminder: if the SBA submission deadline is set in School Profile, the Export page shows how many days remain (ECZ normally requires scores by 31 January of the following year).

7.8 Evidence attachments (optional add-on)

ECZ requires schools to keep SBA evidence — marked student work, photos of practical work, rubrics — for at least 2 years for moderation. Schools with the **SBA evidence add-on** enabled see an **Evidence** panel below each class score sheet on the SBA Marks page:

- Staff attach **photos of student work** (models, projects, practicals) and **marked written work as PDF** — up to 10 MB per file. **Videos are not accepted**.
- Anyone on staff can view and download the files; only a School Administrator can delete them.
- The evidence stays with the score sheet, so a moderator can open a class and see both the frozen marks and the work behind them.

Availability: this feature is **off by default**. It is enabled per school by the system administrator on request, and is billed in addition to the school's subscription. Ask your provider if your school needs it.

8 · Report cards, transcripts & printing

8.1 Report card

From a student's profile click **Report card**. It shows each subject's score and band, the class average and range, the student's overall average and **class position**, your school's **grade** per subject (from the grading scale in School Profile), remarks and signature blocks.

- Use the **term selector** to print a term report (Midterm / End of term) — it computes over only that term's tasks — or the whole-year view, which uses final frozen marks where approved.
- In private schools, report cards are **withheld** for students whose fees are not cleared (Section 10).

8.2 Transcript

From the profile click **Transcript**: the student's identity (including the SIMS Student ID), full enrolment history, SBA results per form year, and the combined Forms 2+3 score out of 20, with a head-teacher signature block.

8.3 How to print or save as PDF

- 1 Open the report card, transcript, certificate or class register.
- 2 Click the **Print** button on the page (or press Ctrl+P / Cmd+P).
- 3 In the browser dialog choose your printer, or choose **"Save as PDF"** as the destination to keep an electronic copy.

The app's menus and header are removed automatically in print — you get a clean document with the school logo and details at the top.

9 · Student transfers between SIMS schools

When a student moves to another school that also uses SIMS, the transfer is handled digitally. The student's permanent SIMS Learner ID follows them; their record and SBA history travel in a sealed “transfer envelope”. Schools never see each other's registers — only the envelope of the student being transferred. Only administrators and head teachers can transfer students.

9.1 Sending a student (the releasing school)

- 1 Open the student's profile → **Transfer out** (available for active students).
- 2 Enter the receiving school's **school code** (e.g. SCH-000123 — obtain it from that school), the reason and effective date.
- 3 Send. The request is assigned a transfer reference (**TRF-2026-000012**) and appears in your **Transfers** → **Outgoing** tab.
- 4 While it is still pending you may **Cancel** it from the Outgoing tab.

9.2 Receiving a student

- 1 Open **Transfers** → **Incoming** (a red badge on the menu shows waiting requests).
- 2 Click a request to preview the envelope: identity, enrolment history, guardians, SBA record.
- 3 Choose **Accept**, **Reject**, or **Request info** (with a note back to the sender).
- 4 On acceptance SIMS automatically imports the student: new student and guardian records in your school, the same Learner ID, and their history attached. The sending school's record is closed as “transferred”.
- 5 Open the imported student (the completed request links straight to them) and use the “**No class assigned**” banner to place them in a stream (Section 6.4).

9.3 Transfer certificate

After the transfer, the releasing school can print a **Transfer certificate** from the (now transferred) student's profile — identity, admission and leaving dates, destination school and the TRF reference, with a signature block.

10 · Fees & payments (private and grant-aided schools)

Open **Payments** (administrators and head teachers; the page is not shown in government schools, where education is free by law).

- **Record a payment** — student, amount (Kwacha), reference/note. Payments form an append-only ledger; to correct a mistake, record an adjustment (negative amount) rather than editing history.
- **By-student view** — every active student with their total paid; click a student to see their ledger.
- **Cleared toggle** — mark a student's fees as cleared for the year (also usable for bursaries with no payment records).
- **Export CSV** — for reconciliation in Excel.

Report-card gate (private schools): a student's report card is withheld until they are marked cleared. Teachers cannot open the card at all; administrators and head teachers see it with a “withheld” warning banner. Grant-aided schools keep the fee register without any report-card gating.

11 · Reports & compliance

Reports is the leadership view for the current year:

- **KPIs** — SBA classes, how many are fully approved, awaiting approval, still in marks entry, or not yet planned; Form 2/3 student counts.
- **Compliance by subject** — a progress bar and stage badge per subject, sorted least-ready first, so problem subjects surface at the top.
- **By-form completion** summary.
- **Export CSV / Print** for meetings and record-keeping.

The **Dashboard** gives leadership a daily cockpit: student/teacher counts, SBA pipeline, and a “needs attention” panel that mirrors the red menu badges.

12 · Working offline

SIMS caches data on your device, so brief internet drops are tolerated:

Works offline	Needs a connection
Viewing students, teachers, classes and previously loaded pages	Signing in
Entering and saving SBA marks for a sheet you have already opened	Admitting a student (number reservation)
	Submitting a sheet for review; moderation/approval
	Creating accounts, transfers, uploads, exports

Offline changes sync automatically when the connection returns. If marks were approved while you were offline, your late edits will be rejected — approved marks stay frozen.

13 · Testing tools (demo data)

For the testing phase only. These pages create **real records** in your school. Use them only in a test school, never in a school holding real student data.

- **SBA Demo Data** (`/dev/seed`, administrators) — one click sets up a demo Mathematics F2 class: stream, students, a teacher, a teaching assignment and exam numbers, ready for walking through the whole SBA flow.
- **Bulk Admit** (`/dev/bulk-admit`, administrators) — admits a batch of test students quickly.

14 · Troubleshooting & FAQ

Problem	What to do
I can't see a menu item this manual describes.	Your role does not include it (Section 1.1). Ask your School Administrator if you believe your role is wrong.
A page looks empty (no classes, no plans...).	Check the Year / Term selectors in the header context bar — you may be looking at the wrong term (Section 3.2).
My role was changed but nothing happened.	Sign out and sign in again to pick up the new permissions.
I forgot my password.	There is no self-service reset yet — contact your School Administrator / system administrator.
The temporary password was lost before first sign-in.	It cannot be shown again. The administrator should contact the system administrator to re-issue the account.
I can see a score sheet but cannot edit it.	Either the sheet has been submitted/approved (locked), or the class is not assigned to you (read-only). Check its status and your teaching assignment.
Submit button is disabled on my score sheet.	Every student needs a score for every task (or a “Not taking” mark), and unsaved changes must be saved first.
Marks are wrong on an approved sheet.	Approved marks are frozen by design and cannot be edited by anyone at the school. Raise the dispute with school leadership; the sheet's history shows who approved and when.
A student is missing from the ECZ export.	The export page tells you why: marks not yet approved, or examination number missing. Fix and re-export.
Report card won't open for a student (private school).	The student's fees are not marked cleared — see Payments (Section 10).
“Permission denied” errors appear.	You tried an action your role doesn't allow, or your session is stale — sign out and in. If it persists, report it: it may be a bug worth logging during testing.
The stream I want to admit into is greyed out.	It is full. Increase its capacity in Academic Structure or choose another stream.

Reporting problems during the testing phase

SIMS is under active testing. When something behaves unexpectedly, please note: **who you were signed in as (role), the page, what you did, what you expected, and what happened** — a screenshot helps greatly — and send it to the project team. Your feedback drives the next release.